**New Zealand Rogaining Association (Inc)** **23rd October 2006**
http://www.rogaine.org.nz/

# NZRA Newsletter − October 2006

## THREE ROGAINES BEFORE CHRISTMAS

### GuyFawkes Rogaine - Saturday 4th November - Western Tararuas

There are 12hr, 6hr, and 3hr courses in an area consisting of farmland, regular walking tracks, and thousands of hectares of lightly tracked bush. This event has something for everyone - great scenery with some tough navigation. Refer to the event website http://www.outdoor.co.nz/rogaine.aspx for more information and an entry form. Entries close October 24th.

### 'Heights of High Country' Office Hours Rogaine, Saturday 25th November

Treat yourself to a 7 hour rogaine before Christmas sets in. This event is in the Canterbury eastern high country between Mt Somers and Lakes Clearwater and Heron. It's located between the Rangitata and Ashburton Rivers, where you've probably never been before. Great views are assured. Modelled on a similar event at Lake Lyndon in 2003, it will be suitable for trampers and others to try rogaining and to test and develop map reading skills. There are no grade and gender classes, all teams being created equal. Details and entry form are available on the NZRA website, http://www.rogaine.org.nz . Entries close 15th November. Enquiries to Grant Hunter, g.hunter@clear.net.nz or phone 03 351-6369.

### December Dash - Saturday 9th December

The December Dash will be held on 85 sq km of Hawkes Bay farmland (65%) and pine forest of varying maturity (35%). Chris Howell is the organiser, for the Hawke's Bay Orienteering Club, with Alan Berry the vetter. This event will provide some good training for the National Champs in March. There will be 12, 8, and 4hr options. For more information and entry form see the event website http://www.hborienteering.com/rogaine/ . Entries close Monday 27th November.

## World Champions in Our Midst

Members of the Kiwi contingent were standout performers at the World Champs.

Congratulations to **Chris Forne & Dennis de Monchy** who were overall winners with a score of 2610 points, 180 points more than the Aussie team of Damon Goerke & Rob Preston. Third on 2370 was the Czech team of Petr Boranek & Miroslav Seidl. The Latvian team of Raimonds Lapins, Anita Liepina & Guntars Mankus was 4th and 1st mixed.

Next came past champions **Greg Barbour (NZ)** & Dave Rowlands (Aus), with a win in the Vets category. **Darren Ashmore & Phil Wood** were 6th with 2230. **Neil Kerrison & Jamie Stewart** finished in 11th place.

**Viv Prince** & Richard Robinson (Aus) won the Mixed Vet by 220pts, and the Supervet team of **Anne Kennedy, Pete Squires & Bill Kennedy** were pressed but managed to retain their mixed title by only 20pts after succumbing to the mid-30s temperatures.

A few other NZ placings were –

- Rhys Burns & Rachel Smith, 21st overall and 4th Mixed
- Joe Jagusch & Tim Sikma, 23rd overall
- Emma & Guy de Lacey, 54th overall and 3rd Mixed Vet
- Phil Bones, Andy Buchanan & Dave Laurie, 59th overall and 4th Supervet
- Nick Tippling & Emmah Ussher, 123rd overall and 2nd Junior.

Other Kiwis not mentioned above also performed meritoriously. For a complete list of results, maps, comments, and photographs (with more to come, probably) see http://www.rogaine2006.com.au/ .

## Wairewa Rogaine wins Maori Language Week Award

The NZ Rogaine Association and Wairewa Runanga have won the "Sports" category of the 2006 Maori Language Week Awards.

The Awards night and dinner were held at the Westpac Stadium (a.k.a. the Cake Tin) in Wellington. **Bruce Meder** (representing the Rogaine Association) and **Maatakiwi Wakefield** (representing Wairewa Runanga) accepted the award and thanked all those that had put work into making the Wairewa Rogaine such a unique event. "It is certainly an honour to be acknowledged in such a way at a national level" said Bruce, "especially as rogaining is not a well-known sport". Of the 14 awards presented that night, this was the only one to come to Te Waipounamu (the South Island).

The trophy, a carved mere, will be formally taken on to Wairewa Marae and blessed.

Congratulations to Bruce for his initiative. See Bruce's report, **E WHAKAHOKI ANA NGA KUPU I ROTO I NGA PUKE (PUTTING THE WORDS BACK IN THE HILLS)** and also the results with winner's route, pictures, and other narrative on the NZRA website http://www.rogaine.org.nz

## New Zealand Championships, March 3rd/4th 2007

Alan Holdaway has been beavering away preparing the course for the NZ Championships. Alan tells us that the terrain is fairly typical south Marlborough country, not unlike a lot of North Canterbury – certainly not flat but plenty of farm tracks (not all marked), some prickly stuff in places but pretty clear overall. There are a total of 73 controls: plenty of easy ones and certainly some harder ones, plenty of contour lines in places but lots of easier routes if looked at carefully. Pre-start planning and strategy will be very important because there are areas of the map that are a long way from home. We are considering having an outpost offering cups of tea and some food in addition to the Hash House at the start/finish.

Vetters will now check the control sites and Alan will start looking at what points to assign them.

Entry forms should be available from the NZRA website in November sometime. Marlborough is a great place to visit, and this is an opportunity for North Island Rogainers to come and enjoy some of our South Island country. Have a look at the photos on the NZRA website, http://www.rogaine.org.nz .

NZRA, October 2006